



Public Policy
Course Handout (Part II)
Semester I 2026-27

In addition to part I (General Handout for all courses appended to the time table) this portion gives further specific details regarding the course.

Course No. : GS F233

Course Title : Public Policy

Instructor-in-charge : Prof. Natasha Hazarika

1. Scope and Objective of the Course: The objective of the course is to make the students aware of the art and craft of policy analysis. This course covers theories, processes and techniques of public policy making, monitoring and evaluation. The course also covers the international agencies and the globalization of policy agenda.

2. Text Book: R.K. Sapru, Public Policy: Art and Craft of Policy Analysis, Second Edition, PHI Learning Private Ltd., New Delhi, 2011.

3. Reference Material- Books/Papers: Eugene Bardach and Eric M. Patashnik, A Practical Guide for Policy Analysis: The Eightfold Path to More Effective Problem Solving by. CQ Press, 2019.

Book chapters, Journal papers, and newspaper reports will be given in advance as reading materials before each session. Students should be prepared to think out of box for maximizing their learning curve.

4. Course Format: The course format will be interactive with regular class discussions and several group exercises and presentations. Students are expected to prepare in advance with the help of reading material provided and through self-initiative.

5. Course Outcomes: By the end of this course, students will be able to understand the nature, scope and significance of Public Policy as a scientific activity; students will be able to analyse various contemporary public policies being made in India and elsewhere; through exposure to this course, students will gain the knowledge required for working in the public and private sector on various policy related issues.

6. Evaluation/Grading:

Component	Weightage	Duration	Date and time	Comments
Class discussions (Linked to attendance)	5%	In class	Every class	





Mid Sem Exam	30%	90 minutes	08/10 FN1	CB
Assignment / Test	30%	To be Announced	To be announced	OB/CB
Compre. Exam.	35%	180 minutes	01/12 FN	CB

7. Course Plan:

Sl. No.	Lecture Session	Reference	Learning Outcomes
Section 1: Nature Scope and Significance of Public Policy			
1	Foundations of Public Policy	Ch. 2	To have an understanding that there is a domain of life that is not private, or purely individual, but held in public.
2	Public Policy and Related Concepts	Ch. 2	Identify the distinction between public policy and related concepts.
3	The Scope and Purpose of Public Policy	Ch. 2	To understand how, why, and to what effect governments pursue particular courses of action and inaction.
Section 2: Perspectives on Public Policy			
4	Lasswell's Vision of Policy Sciences	Ch. 1	An understanding of the policy sciences as proposed by Lasswell.
5	Basic Assumptions in Policy Sciences	Ch. 1	To understand the founding contextual hypotheses of policy study.
6	Criticism of the Rational Policy Analysis	Ch. 3	To understand that public policy is value laden
Section 3: Policy making Cycle			
7	Issue Framing and Agenda Setting	Ch. 3	To understand how one issue can be framed differently leading to different outcomes
8	Policy Design and Justification	Ch. 3	To understand how policies are justified and trade-offs are considered
9	Ex Ante Policy Analysis	Ch. 10	To understand the relationship between policy goals/ outcomes and policy analysis tools
10	Policy Formulation: Models of Public Policy- I	Ch. 4, Ch. 5	Incremental Model, Normative optimum model, Elite theory
11	Models of Public Policy- II	Ch. 6	Institutional Approaches
12	Models of Public Policy- III	Ch. 7	Strategic Planning Approaches
13	Models of Public Policy- IV	Ch. 8	To understand the requirements for rational analysis
14	Models of Public Policy- V	Ch. 8	Rationality Model
15	Introduction to Decision making	Ch. 9	To understand how decision-making influence the entire administrative organization
16	Tools and Techniques of Decision	Ch. 9	Discuss the old and emerging techniques that are





	making		rational for decision-making
17	Strategic Planning and Knowledge Management	Ch. 9	How critical goals are achieved under difficult conditions
Section 6: Policy making Cycle: Policy Implementation			
18	Systems Approach	Ch. 10	Views policies as parts of a larger, interconnected system
19	Top-down Rational System Approaches	Ch. 15	To understand the key characteristics and constraints of top-down policy decisions
20	Bottom-up Approaches	Ch. 15	Emphasizes on the importance of “non-official” actors in the decision-making process
21	Structural Problems	Ch. 18	To understand the many facets of political, administrative problems
22	Contextual Problems	Ch. 18	To understand the many facets of social, cultural problems
Section 7: Policy Monitoring & Evaluation: Techniques and Approaches			
23	Monitoring and Control	Ch. 19	To understand how implemented policies are observed and adjusted
24	Approaches to Policy Monitoring	Ch. 19	To understand the most commonly used approaches for policy monitoring
25	Policy Evaluation	Ch. 20	To understand how to assess the utility of a policy
26	Approaches for Evaluation: Theory of Change; Results Based Management	Ch. 20	To understand how alternative approaches can be implemented in different contexts

8. Chamber Consultation Hour: 5-6 pm (Office: 6168L- by prior appointment).

9. Notices: Notices concerning the course will be displayed on Google Classroom.

10. Plagiarism: Plagiarism and cheating of any kind will be strictly punished through reduction of marks.

**Prof. Natasha
Hazarika
Instructor-in-charge
GS F233 Public Policy**

